

COMPACT TRAVEL ITINERARY

Tokyo and Kyoto by train

10 days in Tokyo and Kyoto by train, built around scenic viewpoints, history and culture and markets and street food.

WHEN
5 Apr – 14 Apr 2027

LENGTH
10 days · 9 nights

WHO
2 adults

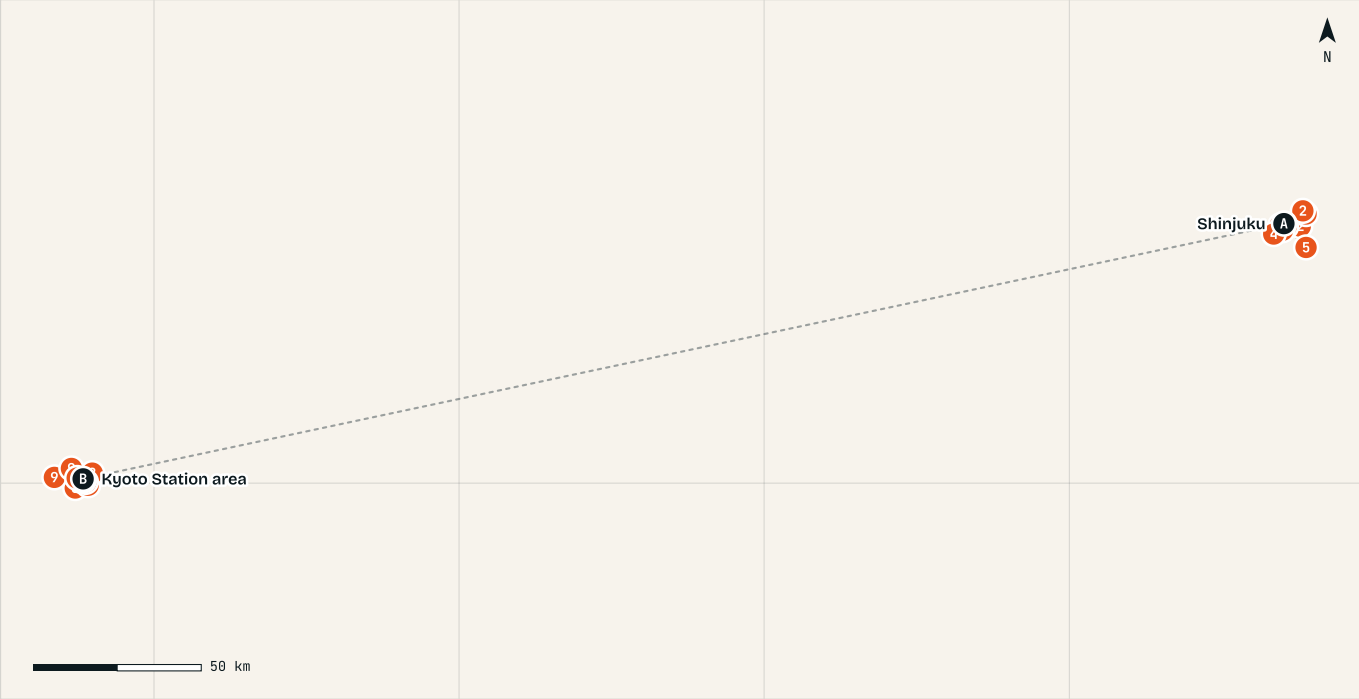
ROUTE
Shinjuku → Kyoto Station area

Planned with Sidequest · 13 November 2026
All times are local (GMT+9, Asia/Tokyo)
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TRIP AT A GLANCE

The shape of the trip

DAYS	STAYS	STOPS	DRIVING
10	2	18	16 km



Letters are where you sleep; numbers are the day each stop falls on. Solid lines follow measured routes; dashed lines are straight connections, not roads.

Where you sleep

A **Shinjuku** · 5 nights · Mon 5 Apr – Fri 9 Apr

B **Kyoto Station area** · 4 nights · Sat 10 Apr – Wed 14 Apr

Getting around

Public transport first: most hops between stops are rides rather than walks; a typical day has about 40 minutes of travel, estimated from...

Built around

Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck · Day 1
Free city-wide view at sunset, satisfying the viewpoint priority without the Skytree crowds

Tokyo National Museum · Day 2
Japan's largest collection of art and artifacts, a solid rainy-day option

Nijo Castle · Day 9
Shogun-era castle with famous nightingale floors, central and easy to reach

Imperial Palace Park · Day 2
A core stop, confirmed as a place on the map, on day 2.

Throughout the trip

- Travel times on this day are Sidequest's estimates from map distance, not measured routes.

DAY BY DAY

10 days

Times are local (GMT+9). A time marked ≈ follows a journey estimated from the map; a part of the day stands in where a journey could not be timed.

DAY 1

Monday 5 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 40 min on the move

Arrive in Shinjuku · Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck

Walk to Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck · 20 min

16:30 1 **Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck** · 45 min
Holds up even if the weather turns.

Walk to Shinjuku · 20 min

18:00 Dinner — なか卯新宿職安通り店

19:00 Free time

DAY 2

Tuesday 6 April · Shinjuku · Moderate day · 3 hr 10 min on the move

Tokyo National Museum + 2 more

Train to Imperial Palace Park · ≈ 35 min

≈ 09:35 1 **Imperial Palace Park** · 1 hr
85 min on foot — further than you said you would usually go, but a strong enough fit that it earns the extra travel.

Train to Tokyo National Museum · ≈ 30 min

≈ 11:05 2 **Tokyo National Museum** · 2 hr

Walk to Yanaka Ginza · ≈ 25 min

≈ 13:30 Lunch — 音音上野バンブーガーデン店

≈ 14:15 3 **Yanaka Ginza** · 1 hr
Old-town shopping street with a local feel, avoiding the tourist-trap districts

Bus to Shinjuku · 1 hr 40 min

≈ 16:55 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Shogun Burger

DAY 3

Wednesday 7 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 35 min on the move

Shinjuku Gyoen

Walk to Shinjuku Gyoen · 20 min

09:20 1 **Shinjuku Gyoen** · 1 hr 30 min
One of Tokyo's best cherry blossom parks, timed perfectly for the April dates

Walk to Golden Gai · 20 min

11:05 Free time

18:00 2 **Golden Gai** · 1 hr 30 min
Tiny bar alleys for one of the late nights the traveller is open to

19:35 Dinner — Wagyu (Halal Vegan) Hamburger Steak & Ramen Shinjuku Kabukicho Restaurant Beef Tei

20:35 Free time

DAY 4

Thursday 8 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 1 hr 30 min on the move

Meiji Jingu & Shimokitazawa

Train to Meiji Jingu · ≈ 25 min

≈ 09:25 1 **Meiji Jingu** · 1 hr
Minutes from where you are staying, so it fits any day.

Train to Shimokitazawa · ≈ 30 min

≈ 10:55 2 **Shimokitazawa** · 1 hr 30 min
A quieter local district with cafes and vintage shops, a break from the famous sights

≈ 12:25 Lunch — coto cafe

Bus to Shinjuku · ≈ 35 min

≈ 13:45 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Chaya Macrobiotics Isetan Shinjuku

DAY 5

Friday 9 April · Shinjuku · Light day · 1 hr 35 min on the move

Odaiba Seaside Park

Train to Odaiba Seaside Park · ≈ 45 min

≈ 09:45 Free time

≈ 16:30 1 **Odaiba Seaside Park** · 1 hr 30 min
160 min on foot — further than you said you would usually go, but a strong enough fit that it earns the extra travel.

Bus to Shinjuku · ≈ 50 min

≈ 18:50 Dinner — Dancing Crab Tokyo

DAY 6

Saturday 10 April · Kyoto Station area · Light day · 4 hr 35 min on the move

On to Kyoto Station area · Kyoto Railway Museum

Moving on: Shinjuku → Kyoto Station area

09:00 Breakfast — Breakfast in Shinjuku before heading out

Train to Kyoto Station area · ≈ 3 hr 30 min
Train to Kyoto Railway Museum · ≈ 30 min

≈ 13:30 Lunch — Shava Liva

≈ 14:15 1 **Kyoto Railway Museum** · 1 hr 30 min
Sits right in the middle of famous and quiet, which is the mix you asked for.

Bus to Kyoto Station area · ≈ 35 min

≈ 16:20 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — Sinamo

NOTE You move from Shinjuku to Kyoto Station area today.

DAY 7

Sunday 11 April · Kyoto Station area · Light day · 50 min on the move

Kiyomizu-dera

05:30 Breakfast — Early breakfast in Kyoto Station area before heading out

Train to Kiyomizu-dera · ≈ 25 min

≈ 06:25 1 **Kiyomizu-dera** · 1 hr 30 min
Hillside temple with a famous wooden stage view over Kyoto, worth an early visit

≈ 07:55 Free time

≈ 11:30 Lunch — 上島珈琲店京都寺町店

Walk to Kyoto Station area · time not measured

Late morning Free time

Early evening Dinner — Motoi

NOTE 1 travel leg on this day could not be timed; times are shown as parts of the day.

DAY 8

Monday 12 April · Kyoto Station area · Moderate day · 1 hr 35 min on the move

Gion District + 2 more

Walk to Nishiki Market · 15 min

09:15 1 **Nishiki Market** · 1 hr
Kyoto's famous food market, good for a wandering lunch

Train to Ginkaku-ji · ≈ 30 min

≈ 10:45 2 **Ginkaku-ji** · 1 hr
The silver pavilion at the end of the Philosopher's Path, quieter than Kinkaku-ji

Train to Gion District · ≈ 30 min

≈ 12:15 Lunch — キーズカフェ 京都八坂の塔店

≈ 13:00 3 **Gion District** · 1 hr 30 min
Traditional geisha district, best explored in the quieter early evening

Walk to Pontocho Alley · ≈ 15 min

≈ 14:45 Free time

≈ 18:00 4 **Pontocho Alley** · 1 hr 30 min
Riverside dining alley for the trip's one special meal

Walk to Kyoto Station area · 10 min

≈ 19:40 Dinner — お食事 Choice Restaurant

≈ 20:40 Free time

DAY 9

Tuesday 13 April · Kyoto Station area · Moderate day · 2 hr 20 min on the move

Nijo Castle + 2 more

Train to Tenryu-ji · ≈ 45 min

≈ 09:45 1 **Tenryu-ji** · 1 hr
Zen garden temple adjoining the bamboo grove, pairs naturally with the walk

Train to Kinkaku-ji · ≈ 35 min

≈ 11:20 2 **Kinkaku-ji** · 45 min
The golden pavilion, a must-see despite crowds, best early

Train to Nijo Castle · ≈ 30 min

≈ 12:35 Lunch — Piopiko

≈ 13:20 3 **Nijo Castle** · 1 hr 30 min

Walk to Kyoto Station area · ≈ 30 min

≈ 15:20 Free time

≈ 18:00 Dinner — 焼肉どうらく 京都六角通り店

DAY 10

Wednesday 14 April · Kyoto Station area · Light day

Departure

09:00 Free time

ACCOMMODATION & TRANSPORT

Where you sleep, and how you move

STAY	NIGHTS	DATES	STATUS
Shinjuku	5	Mon 5 Apr – Fri 9 Apr	TO BOOK
Kyoto Station area	4	Sat 10 Apr – Wed 14 Apr	TO BOOK

Getting around

Public transport first: most hops between stops are rides rather than walks; a typical day has about 40 minutes of travel, estimated from...

- 1 hotel move, in the order that keeps the journeys between bases shortest.
- Consider a Suica or Pasmo IC card for all local trains, buses and convenience stores
- A Hakone Freepass covers the loop's trains, ropeway, cable car and boat

Moving between stays

DAY	FROM	TO	HOW
6	Shinjuku	Kyoto Station area	Train · ≈ 3 hr 30 min

BOOKINGS & PREPARATION

Before you go

What to book

ITEM	WHEN	WHAT TO DO	STATUS
5 nights in Shinjuku Essential	Mon 5 Apr	Book somewhere to sleep in Shinjuku	TO BOOK
4 nights in Kyoto Station area Essential	Sat 10 Apr	Book somewhere to sleep in Kyoto Station area	TO BOOK
Train: Shinjuku → Kyoto Station area Recommended	Sat 10 Apr	Book the train to Kyoto Station area By Seats usually open about 30 days ahead	TO BOOK

To do before you leave

- [ ] Check the official entry requirements for your nationality before you book anything.
- [ ] Check current cherry blossom forecast as timing shifts yearly
- [ ] Check opening hours and any closures for Owakudani ropeway
- [ ] Check entry requirements and any visa rules for Japan before travel
- [ ] Reserve Ghibli Museum tickets well in advance, they sell out early
- [ ] Check teamLab Planets ticket availability and book online

PRACTICAL REFERENCE

Keep this page handy

EMERGENCY **110**

The general emergency number in Japan (119 ambulance and fire). Confirm locally; reference facts compiled by Sidequest.

DRIVING
On the left

MONEY
JPY

PLUGS
Type A, B · 100 V

CALLING CODE
+81

TIME ZONE
GMT+9 · Asia/Tokyo

Scan to open

This trip in Sidequest
Your live copy: changes, Today view and offline pages.

Day 1 in Google Maps
Tokyo Metropolitan Government Building Observation Deck

Day 2 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Day 3 in Google Maps
2 stops, in order

Day 4 in Google Maps
2 stops, in order

Day 5 in Google Maps
Odaiba Seaside Park

Day 6 in Google Maps
Kyoto Railway Museum

Day 7 in Google Maps
Kiyomizu-dera

Day 8 in Google Maps
4 stops, in order

Day 9 in Google Maps
3 stops, in order

Credits

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